MONTHLY UPDATE

Digital Payments and Fintech: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *47 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

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The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

The monetary and banking council authorised a mobile operator's subsidiary on 23 September to constitute itself as a payment service provider, the first such subsidiary under the 2025 regime; it must obtain its licence within twelve months before it can operate.

Angola

A renminbi route opened for Angola-China trade: the largest private bank signed a clearing memorandum with Bank of China on 8 September, giving it a renminbi clearing account and indirect access to China's cross-border interbank payment system. No volume or value is published. A trade publication reported the instant-payment scheme processing 4.48 million transfers worth Kz 123.85bn in August 2026, the number of operations up 53.3% in a year.

Benin

Online tax filing is spreading beyond the large taxpayers. The tax directorate opens its declaration and payment platform to the small-business tax centres of Parakou from 21 September, Comè from 28 September and Lokossa from 5 October. Proof of an official mission is now given on a mobile application, where the agent identifies by personal identification number, shares a location and validates by fingerprint, under the system that pays mission expenses electronically.

Botswana

A fourth came with a bank's annual results: FNBB said its eWallet will send funds directly into all three mobile-money platforms, with no start date or fee published.

Burkina Faso

Certified electronic invoicing moved from rule to product. The tax administration announced that certified invoicing systems go on sale from 7 September 2026, under the 2025 order that established the certified invoice. No price, supplier list or take-up figure is published.

Burundi

The East African Legislative Assembly's accounts committee reported on 8 October 2026 that components of the regional payment-systems integration project were unfinished when its grant closed in June, and recommended an audit and a costed completion plan; the central bank said it remains committed to joining the East African Payment System by December.

Cameroon

A third mobile money provider was licensed as a payment institution by finance ministry order of 21 July, announced on 17 September, into a market held by the two main operators. It has not yet launched. A Cameroonian fintech and a logistics group presented to Douala traders a pilot that pays Chinese suppliers in yuan from CFA francs and consolidates and tracks the cargo.

Cape Verde

Card traffic held steady through August. Residents made 4,992,880 operations worth CVE 21,159.9m on the vinti4 network, 3,768,595 of them card purchases, 0.3 per cent fewer than in July, on the central bank's monthly figures.

Central African Republic

The regulator's first-half 2026 market observatory counts more than 702,000 active mobile-money clients at the end of June 2026, from operators' returns.

Chad

The electronic money market has more providers and no newer numbers. Two further providers have joined the two mobile operators' services, and users report fees they consider high, with competition presented as the hope rather than the position, against 160,000 to 240,000 accounts over 2020 to 2022. No current account count, transaction volume, tariff schedule or regulator series is published, so the market's growth is described and not measured.

A September press account places the 3,000 payment terminals in the revenue offices, with electronic invoicing compulsory under the 2026 finance law, and finds power cuts, thin provincial connectivity and agents' limited skills holding use back. No transaction count has been published. The telecoms and digital economy minister set out a transformation of the state postal operator, with a postal bank in the medium term and an integrated payment platform, no budget or date stated.

Comoros

An account of the central bank's 2025 annual report, published on 3 September, records deployment of the clearing platform for cheques and transfers alongside the interbank switch, under a financial inclusion strategy for 2025 to 2030 that targets 75 per cent inclusion. The same account puts the banking sector's balance sheet at KMF 262.3 billion at the end of 2025 and non-performing loans at 9 per cent, against 14 per cent in 2024.

Congo

A domestic platform, Yano, launched on 14 September for group collections and merchant payments across mobile-money operators through a QR code or link, holding no funds itself, backed by a FCFA 655m incubation vehicle. Its co-founder gives no user or transaction figure, and no licence is stated.

Cote d'Ivoire

The regional central bank said the Ivorian Treasury, having met all its requirements, already makes regular bulk payments through the Union's instant-payment platform.

DR Congo

The revenue chain's own record came into dispute. The tax directorate wrote to the finance minister on 3 September alleging deleted and back-dated receipts on the ISYS-REGIES platform, and the central bank replied on 10 September that validated transactions are traceable and cannot be altered, explaining the gaps against its accounting system. No independent audit is published. The national economy ministry announced the official national launch of the LOBA consumer-protection platform from 6 October 2026, through the competition commission and the sector regulators.

Egypt

On 13 August eFinance, which operates the government payments network, agreed the full acquisition of an Egyptian non-bank lender to small and medium firms, and on 20 September its shareholders approved buying 99.32% for EGP 956.37m in cash and a swap of 146.08m new shares. Neither record states any separation between running government payment rails and holding a lending book that runs on them.

The telecom regulator counted 57.01m operator wallets in the first half of 2026, up 23% in a year, with 67% registered to men.

The largest private bank's digital-bank venture, holding preliminary approval, put its planned investment at up to US$300m ahead of a pilot for individual and diaspora customers. The central bank is laying groundwork for a digital pound, wholesale before any retail use, with no pilot, design paper or date published.

Six Egyptian banks have applied to the central bank for final approval to connect InstaPay to the continental payment system, the system's chief executive said in September. InstaPay does not yet carry cross-border transactions, and neither the banks nor a launch date were named. Afreximbank is also connecting the continental card scheme to the national Meeza network (20 September), at an early stage with no availability date.

Equatorial Guinea

The one payments instrument in the window is a standing one, surfaced by a sales pitch: a Presidency order of 2025 prohibits cash collection of any tax, fee or contribution in the administration, requiring official bank accounts or authorised electronic platforms, cited when a domestic e-wallet provider presented itself to the transport ministry as a collection channel. The order's text, and whether collection has moved off cash, are not in the record held.

Eswatini

A bank wallet is closing for want of use: Standard Bank will decommission its Unayo platform by 31 December 2026, saying only about 30% of its 200,000 retail clients transact on it. The bank began telling customers that its Instant Money service will return as the wallet closes, with no terms announced. The provident fund launched Express

Claims, a three-hour payout target piloted for claims up to E5,000, with a card payment gateway for contributions. The ICT principal secretary said on 9 October 2026 that the government plans to use post offices as community digital centres for citizen authentication, document verification and digital payments in rural areas.

Ethiopia

The challenger's wallet more than doubled its monthly active users to 2.58 million in the quarter to June, yet contributes about 2% of the unit's service revenue against 45.6% in Kenya, and its cardless ATM withdrawal was extended to Awash Bank's ATM network.

Scale and use are far apart. A diagnostic report counts more than 135 million mobile wallets opened against fewer than one adult in ten holding a mobile money account, and 0.4% relying on one alone, while the national switch says its instant-payment service passed 1 million transactions in a day in May. The central bank put digital financial transactions at 33 trillion birr in fiscal year 2025/26, a director's figure given at a finance forum on 30 September with no published series behind it. An assessment of the second financial inclusion strategy counts 157.6 million mobile money accounts at June 2026, 29.56 per cent of them active, and about eight billion digital transactions worth over 34 trillion birr in fiscal year 2025/26, with some banks charging up to 11 per cent for transfers to mobile wallets. A licensed payment-system operator and an international card scheme signed a framework agreement to roll out 148,000 contactless acceptance devices to merchants, certified as tax cash registers. Awash Bank and Oromia Bank launched international payment cards on 8 October 2026, eight months after the central bank's amendment of 11 February 2026 let authorised banks issue internationally accepted cards to foreign-currency account holders.

Gabon

The Council of Ministers adopted a bill ratifying and amending the digital payments ordinance, regulating payment-solution providers and moving payments progressively to digital form.

Gambia

The country appears here in a survey of other people's pilots rather than in an account of its own. A UN development agency names a wallet pilot in the Gambia among blockchain-based payment-distribution schemes said to cut distribution costs from about 10% to as little as 2%. The cost figure is the agency's own and describes its portfolio rather than this pilot; no caseload, value distributed or evaluation is held for the Gambian instance.

Ghana

The virtual-asset regime acquired its coordinating machinery. A five-agency committee is constituted and chaired by the central bank governor, joining the securities regulator, the finance ministry, the cyber security authority and the financial intelligence centre, working towards having the Virtual Asset Service Providers Act fully in force by 2027, and on 4 September the securities regulator admitted a second sandbox cohort of ten participants, run with the central bank to test and refine the framework the Act introduced, one of them a stablecoin infrastructure provider testing stablecoin payment, fiat settlement and wallet infrastructure under supervision. The cohort list, the first cohort's outcomes and the sandbox's exit criteria are not published.

The central bank widened its enforcement. On 8 September it named a second list of 20 unlicensed digital loan apps, five weeks after the first, warning banks and payment providers not to process for them; the register of licensed providers it undertook to publish is still not out.

On 23 September a fintech began opening bank-backed virtual accounts for its Ghanaian customers through an API integration with Universal Merchant Bank, which the central bank and the securities regulator had approved to offer virtual accounts to eligible virtual-asset businesses. The approval date is not stated.

On 6 October the central bank named a further twenty unlicensed loan apps and told banks and payment providers not to process for them, the third such list since August. A new dedicated electronic money issuer began operations the next day, and the governor used the occasion to give the measure of the market: about 85.8 million registered mobile money accounts in August 2026, of which about 26.4 million had been used in the previous ninety days.

Guinea

Conakry Terminal launched online payment for port clearance with two fintechs on 18 September 2026. Its director-general put uptake at more than 300 clients and over 10,000 transactions worth more than 60 billion Guinean francs, against an aim of raising the digital share of the terminal's transactions from 20% to 50%. The regional digital integration project called on 1 October for a firm to design and implement a national payment scheme over nine months, covering its governance, rules, security and a pilot, in support of the national switching company and the central bank; expressions of interest close on 23 October.

Kenya

The platforms Kenyans use to be paid changed their rules one after another over the past year: an international payments provider imposed restrictions, a domestic dollar-banking service withdrew that product, a remittance operator paused its wallet and a streaming platform cut monetisation. Four separate commercial decisions rather than a regulatory change; no user numbers, values or regulator response are held.

The regulator's June-quarter return put mobile money subscriptions at 54,005,800, up 1.2 per cent in the quarter, while registered agents fell from 602,470 to 568,463. Subscriptions count accounts, not people.

Tanzania's competition regulator put KCB Group's stake in the payments company Pesapal at 22.23% in a notice of 21 August, the first public figure for a deal announced in November 2025; the price is undisclosed and approval is pending.

An independent switch launched a domestic card scheme on 22 September for banks to issue physical and virtual cards across its ATMs, point-of-sale terminals and agents. No issuing institution, consumer date or price is disclosed.

The central bank licensed 29 more digital credit providers on 30 September, taking the total to 281 from more than 900 applications since March 2022, with 9,596,509 loans worth KSh165.1bn made by licensed lenders by August. A tier-one bank's fintech arm launched a wallet that sends to mobile-money services and bank accounts; no user figure is published. An industry association reported the bank-owned instant payment switch's chief executive saying a portable account identifier is ready and institutions must begin mapping customers to it.

Lesotho

A whole-of-government e-payment gateway is being developed, to be run by the central bank and integrated with the national single window, reported on 27 September. The dominant operator launched electronic airtime top-up without physical vouchers in the week of 4 September.

Liberia

The finance minister targeted the national electronic payment switch for March 2027 in a speech to a diaspora conference near Washington, reported on 28 September. No budget line or implementer is published.

The African Development Bank published on 27 September the completion report of its project to put customs tax collection on an e-payment solution hosted by the revenue authority. No outcome or collection figure is stated with it.

Libya

At a Tripoli conference on 7 September the central bank governor announced a link to the Arab regional payments platform, a study track on a central bank digital currency and stablecoins, a cyber-skills programme, and a pilot for accession to China's cross-border interbank system targeted at early 2027. None carries an instrument, budget, participant list or delivery date, and the transfer-value figure the same account reports is not taken into the repository.

The central bank rewrote the wallet rules. Circular 9/2026 replaces the 2017 instructions for licensed electronic-payment companies, setting daily limits for Libyans of LYD 100,000 person to person, 500,000 person to business and 2 million business to business, lower limits for foreigners, and opening wallets to lawful residents on a passport or residence document and a phone number in their name. No count of wallets in use is published.

September public-sector salaries were paid through the Ratibak Lahzi system with about 1.75 million of 2.2 million public employees registered, 79%, against 76% in July; the central bank is automating complaint handling for undisbursed salaries with the finance ministry. The central bank put electronic transactions at about LD 865 billion by the end of September 2026. A private bank is to launch payments to China through a Chinese payment platform from its own application, capped at US$5,000 a transaction and US$50,000 a year. The banking sector development forum stopped pursuing its Zero Cash initiative on 7 September for want of an executive framework from the central bank.

Madagascar

On 15 September the finance ministry announced a task force with the banking supervisor and the telecoms regulator on lost money, failed transactions and slow complaint handling, with no start date given. The African Development Bank and AXIAN launched a digital finance programme on 2 September targeting 34,000 women-led businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal through the Mixx and MVola platforms, under a US$160 million senior corporate loan approved to the group in January 2025 with a US$2.5 million grant for financial literacy and credit access and more than US$10 million allocated for 22,000 women entrepreneurs in Madagascar through MVola. The grant is not a lending pool, and no enrolment or disbursement figure is published for the programme itself.

BGFIBank Madagasikara presented its Gasy Money mobile-banking app on Friday 18 September, open to non-customers on any network, including people without a bank account, with transfers to other app accounts, bank accounts and Airtel Money. No user or transaction figure is published. The largest mobile money operator made merchant payments free for customers, the fee borne by the merchant, and reported close to 4 million users, more than 60,000 cashpoints and more than 50,000 accepting merchants. The capital's urban commune launched the digitalisation of its markets, registering traders and replacing paper tickets with merchant cards debited by payment terminals.

Malawi

The police service introduced electronic payment of traffic fines from the week of 4 September 2026, at headquarters and in the six police regions, through commercial banks and both mobile money services. A non-governmental programme that pays lump sums of about US$550 to the poorest adults by mobile money was expanded by a US$150m donation; how many households the expansion reaches is not stated.

Mauritania

A retrospective rather than an operator disclosure, and it is the repository's first account of where the market came from. A state-owned bank's mobile service, announced in late 2019 as the country's first fully mobile bank and launched in 2020, is credited with making the domestic digital payments market rather than entering a mature one: opening an account from a phone, transferring and paying merchants were new to a wide part of the population, and transferring money by phone has since become a daily behaviour. The piece is a defence against complaints of faults and slowness, and it carries no user count, transaction volume, value, agent network or outage record — so what the service does now cannot be sized from it.

Morocco

The central bank and its Emirati counterpart signed a memorandum in Abu Dhabi to explore interlinking their instant payment platforms, national card switches and financial messaging systems, with mutual acceptance of domestic cards and an exchange of expertise on central bank digital currencies. A second memorandum covers supervision and Islamic finance. No timetable is stated for either. A central bank working paper said a proof of concept built with the IMF and the World Bank confirmed the technical feasibility of a retail central bank digital currency, with any issuance a long-term prospect.

Mozambique

The public payroll became a credit rail. A memorandum between the dominant mobile money operator, a microbank and the state financial information centre puts a salary-advance product on the operator's short code for more than 380,000 civil servants. It is a memorandum rather than a live product: no launch date, interest rate, advance ceiling, repayment mechanism or default treatment is published, and nothing describes how payroll data would reach the lender.

Central bank figures put electronic money accounts at 130.9 per 100 adults in the second quarter of 2026, against 33.8 for traditional bank accounts, with 144.7 per 100 men against 118.5 per 100 women. A commercial bank and the dominant mobile money operator signed a memorandum on 2 September to let merchants move mobile-money receipts directly into their bank accounts. The central bank governor said the country will join the regional settlement system with the metical in the first quarter of 2027, so that invoices from South Africa are settled from metical accounts. The central bank governor was reported saying the metical could be used for regional payments through the settlement system from January 2027. The central bank licensed a payments aggregator as a payment service provider, among the first such licences, allowing merchants to be onboarded directly across the three mobile money operators.

Namibia

The system acquired a public name. The instant payment solution is carried publicly as WayaMe, operated by Instant Payments Namibia under the central bank, with customers transacting through their existing bank applications, wallets or USSD services while the payment is routed through the national instant-payment infrastructure, designed

to carry bank-to-bank, bank-to-wallet, wallet-to-bank and wallet-to-wallet payments between participating institutions. No participant list, transaction volume, value or fee schedule is published, so interoperability is a stated design property rather than a measured one.

Niger

The operator of the vehicle one-stop shop opened payment of some of its services by mobile money on 1 October, by app or an offline code; which services are covered is not stated.

Nigeria

One private figure crossed a round number. A digital bank passed 30 million registered users in Nigeria on its own count, which is a registration total rather than an active or transacting one and has no earlier figure on the ledger to read it against.

The survey behind the country's headline inclusion figure entered the repository in full, and it is three years old. Formal financial inclusion reached 64% of adults, about 71.7 million, in 2023 from 56% in 2020, banking uptake moving 51% to 52% and non-bank formal products 32% to 57%, on 26,930 interviews across all 36 states and the federal capital territory; exclusion fell ten percentage points, but roughly 28.9 million adults remain outside the formal system and the share counted financially healthy fell to 16%. Fieldwork ran August to October 2023, so every payment-system change since sits outside it.

On the cross-border rail the operator reported Nigeria–Rwanda volumes approaching and in places exceeding Nigeria–Ghana, corridors with Cameroon, Niger and Benin growing on trade in Nigerian goods, and church contributions remitted from elsewhere in Africa as a notable component of activity — no volumes, values or period attached to any of it. In the other direction, diaspora inflows held steady at US$21.8bn in 2025 on central bank figures, against an average 8.46% cost to send US$200 into the region and app-based rivals quoting 2–3% on the London–Lagos corridor.

A new inclusion survey replaced the 2023 baseline. The 2026 round puts digital financial services use at 64 per cent of adults from 47 per cent, mobile money at 38 per cent from 12 per cent, and exclusion at 21 per cent, with 53 per cent of the poorest fifth still excluded and 92 per cent of agricultural workers paid in cash. The same round puts overall use at 79 per cent of adults and formal inclusion at 73 per cent, past the national strategy's 70 per cent target. At its launch the central bank said it had completed its review of the third inclusion strategy and begun the fourth, and the trade minister inaugurated a steering committee for a strategy to let firms borrow against verified digital invoices.

Two private rails widened what they carry. Remita, whose rails carry government and enterprise payments, launched a consumer super app on 22 September with multi-bank aggregation, transfers to other African countries over the continental rail and a loans marketplace matching borrowers on NIN and BVN verification; no user or transfer figure is published. Moniepoint began selling shares in the Dangote refinery's public offer through its agent terminals in all 774 local government areas, buyers identified by BVN and capped at N100,000 each.

The clearing operator said its ISO 20022 payment stack had passed 100 million successful transactions by late September, on its own figure, with no value or institution count given. A banking group's audited half-year statements put its payments subsidiary's profit at NGN 7.81bn, the first position the repository holds on that switch. A listing prospectus, as reported, shows a central bank directive required an operator's mobile-money arm to hand its 25% stake in a payment service bank back to the network company.

Rwanda

The central bank put the gap on its own record: 85.3% of Rwandans hold a digital account and 92% still pay mainly in cash, and it launched a national campaign touring the districts to close it, with no target published.

The online VAT order's own deadline has passed unmet: the revenue authority was to have a supplier registration portal in place by 29 July, and a tax adviser recorded on 15 September that it is not yet in place, while unregistered suppliers already accrue penalties.

Bank of Kigali signed in Xiamen on 8 September to join China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System as a direct participant, the first bank in Rwanda to do so, giving it renminbi clearing and settlement without intermediary banks. The agreement was announced on 22 September with no transaction volume. eKash has carried more than 10.5 million transactions and moved over RWF 960 billion since its launch on 14 July, at a 98.6 per cent success rate; the central bank acknowledges that users still report delays and failed transfers. The central bank governor said a digital agricultural lending platform is in a six-month pilot with four lenders, meant to cut farmers' wait for a loan from weeks to under 48 hours. The central bank reported active accounts on the national payment switch at 10.3 million in September 2026, against 2.03 million a year earlier, and a rejection rate below 2%.

Senegal

The country leads its monetary union on electronic money, on figures that also show how little of the union's account base is alive. It held 29.7 per cent of union electronic-money outstandings and 26.5 per cent of large microfinance assets at the end of 2025, hosting 81 large institutions and 2.28 million of the union's 14.66 million accounts; union-wide, electronic-money outstandings rose 35.2 per cent to CFAF 1,923.2 billion and accounts reached 172.9 million, of which only 60.6 million were active. The domestic market is a duopoly, one provider on close to 80 per cent of outstandings against the other's 19 per cent. The African Development Bank and AXIAN launched a digital finance programme on 2 September targeting 34,000 women-led businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal through the Mixx and MVola platforms, under a US$160 million senior corporate loan approved to the group in January 2025 with a US$2.5 million grant for financial literacy and credit access. No Senegalese share of the programme's target, and no enrolment or disbursement figure, is published.

At the end of February the central bank counted 31 licensed payment institutions across the union, 11 of them in Senegal, a licence category created in January 2024 for firms that are neither banks nor e-money issuers.

Seychelles

The social protection registry gained a use: an agreement signed in September puts post-disaster cash transfers on its beneficiary registry and payment rails, with no value or trigger stated.

Sierra Leone

A self-service route into pensions was announced. The social security trust is to launch an application for pensioners and contributors with a short-code fallback for feature phones, biometric verification, and integration with the three mobile-money services. It is announced rather than launched: no launch date, pensioner count, transaction route or fee arrangement is published, and the short-code fallback is the part that decides whether it reaches anyone outside the smartphone base.

South Africa

Cape Town will pilot cashless payment at three of its 18 driving licence testing centres, at Brackenfell, Fish Hoek and Strand, from 1 October, after six service offices stopped taking cash on 1 September. No alternative for residents without cards has been stated.

The rand stablecoin ZARU, listed on an exchange on 7 August, went live on 22 September on Circle's Arc blockchain as a founding pair on its StableFX foreign-exchange platform, trading against USDC. Standard Bank and Absa are named among the network's banking partners. No transaction volume has been published.

The app-only Bank Zero recorded its first break-even month in August 2026 on 275,000 direct customers, and is onboarding 500,000 customers of the remittance firm Mukuru through an alliance-banking platform live since January. The figures are the bank's own.

Paystack introduced card payment inside the Shopify merchant checkout without redirection, with a Shopify integration for its in-store terminal, reported on 25 September. No merchant count has been published.

An association of non-bank payment providers said the last of the Payments Association of South Africa's functions passed to the Reserve Bank and PayInc on 2 September, and that the Bank is taking its papers into account in an interchange determination project. It has also sent the Bank a proposal on merchant acceptance of PayShap. No draft interchange determination has been published.

Absa put an institutional digital-asset custody service live on 21 September, built on Ripple's custody technology, for asset managers, non-bank financial institutions, corporates and treasuries. It is not a retail offering, and no client or asset figures have been published. The rules are being rebuilt alongside the rail: three payments executives set out at a Johannesburg roundtable a proposed activity-based regulatory model letting non-banks and fintechs offer payment services directly rather than through a sponsoring bank, alongside richer payment data and faster cross-border rails. It is an industry account, not a regulator's publication: no draft licensing instrument or commencement date is held.

South Sudan

The trade minister met one operator's management, reported 8 October 2026, on reopening its mobile money transactions and restoring services; the date and cause of the suspension are not stated.

Sudan

The payment outages ran on. Intermittent failures of the dominant banking app and another e-payment service pushed traders back to cash and prompted a social-media campaign to withdraw funds and switch banks. The finance ministry signed a framework with 11 companies to supply portable electronic collection devices to state institutions.

The gap between cash and app money drew an order from the other side of the war. The RSF commander told traders in areas his forces hold to charge one price whether customers pay in cash or through banking applications such as Bankak, ending the premium on app payments. In Khartoum, meanwhile, converting app balances into banknotes cost 5 per cent at most shops and up to 10 per cent at some, amid a cash shortage and restricted banking applications.

The central bank revoked Sudan Pay Digital's mobile-payment and switching licence on 28 September by Administrative Decision No. 65 of 2026, citing the 2026 banking act and the 2020 and 2013 payment regulations and giving no reason; it is the second switch licence withdrawn since July. On 27 September the finance ministry signed an agreement with MTN Sudan for text-message services on its electronic collection system, so that the

operator's subscribers can use the system and follow their transactions. A second operator, Zain, signed a text-message services agreement for the state collection system on 4 October, letting its subscribers use the system and follow their transactions. A bank launched a USSD banking service with a mobile operator, needing neither internet nor a smartphone and aimed at humanitarian payments. The finance ministry signed a contract with Sudani on 8 October 2026 for text-message services supporting the system, the third such agreement with a mobile operator. Disruptions in the days before 9 October 2026 again left the application's customers unable to reach or transfer their money, amid cash and fuel shortages; the bank apologised. The bank launched a USSD transfer service on one mobile operator's SIMs, reported 10 October 2026, so customers can transact without a smartphone or internet.

Tanzania

The state operator took its card into a stadium. The African Development Bank and AXIAN launched a digital finance programme on 2 September targeting 34,000 women-led businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal through the Mixx and MVola platforms, under a US$160 million senior corporate loan approved to the group in January 2025 with a US$2.5 million grant for financial literacy and credit access. The Tanzanian channel is the Mixx group savings service run with a local bank, which the same account puts at more than 68,000 registered members and 16,000 savings groups by December 2024; no target, enrolment or disbursement figure is published for the country. A bank and the Zanzibar health fund signed a memorandum on member enrolment and contribution collection.

Togo

Certified electronic invoicing is not yet running. The revenue office briefed about 50 firms on 10 September on a gradual rollout, and standardised paper invoices stay valid until launch.

Digital tickets are piloting on the state bus operator's student routes, with network rollout planned by the end of 2026.

The revenue office launched e-TPU on 17 September, letting small and micro enterprises, artisans and traders declare and pay the single business tax from a phone without visiting a tax centre. No uptake figure has been published yet.

Tunisia

The central bank's own figures put the settlement system at about 722 payments a day worth 3.255 billion dinars. About 1,568,000 pupils, some 75%, registered online for the 2026-2027 school year and about 287,300 students by end-September 2026, paying through the postal operator's free wallets and payment application.

Uganda

On 22 September Afreximbank issued a US$29m guarantee to the operator of the regional customs bond platform, which was piloted in Uganda from August 2025 and launched across the Community in March 2026. No uptake figure is published.

A microfinance bank moved onto a switch operator's network on 22 September, putting deposits, withdrawals, loan repayments and bill payments with more than 21,000 agents and its debit cards on more than 650 ATMs. No cost or customer target is stated.

The expressway then moved partly off cash. On 25 September MTN Mobile Money toll payment launched with the works ministry at the Busega, Kajjansi and Mpala plazas on two designated lanes, the motorist approving a PIN prompt on the phone. No other wallet and no fee is named.

Zambia

The account base under the inclusion figure was stated: 14.7m registered mobile money accounts in 2024 on the monetary fund's financial access survey, of which 77% hold a balance, against one adult in five holding any account at all in 2011, with the central bank phasing out cheque clearing behind it. Registered accounts are not people, and the balance share is the only measure of activity the repository holds against the count.

Trade with China gained a direct channel: a commercial bank launched renminbi settlement over China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System in Lusaka on 23 September, with the commerce ministry presenting it as a cut in conversion and intermediary costs. No volume, fee or participant count was published.

Zimbabwe

The World Bank warned that the tax on intermediated money transfers discourages digital transactions, weakens intermediation and pushes activity toward cash, as banks and businesses press for its abolition. No government response is recorded.

The stock exchange launched InvoiceX, an invoice-discounting marketplace under its entrepreneurship exchange, reported on 24 September: financiers bid for buyer-authenticated invoices of US$1,000 to US$1.5m and suppliers are to be paid within 48 hours for fees of 0.65 per cent. Whether financing is with recourse is not stated. The central bank governor said it is negotiating to build a real-time payments system on India's UPI technology, with an agreement possible by 31 October 2026. The system's parent bank said Zimbabwe is processing US$5.8m a month through the pan-African payment and settlement system.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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